



12 Small-Space Survival Strategies

While living in a smaller space can be a great way to simplify your life and reduce overhead costs, the process of reducing and cramming our worldly possessions into drastically reduced square-footage allotments can be frustrating to say the least. Here are a dozen ways to survive in a small space without completely losing your mind.

1. Under-shelf storage space use

You can really get some storage mileage here by hanging things underneath every available shelf with extra space on the bottom side. In the kitchen, this means more room for coffee mugs, cooking utensils, and the odd gravy boat. In the bathroom, it can mean moving hair dryers and curling irons out of storage space better used for bulk tissue and shampoo purchases.

2. Closet organizers

Lots of products are out there on the market now. Pick ones that work for your space and budget. You'll be amazed how much more you can cram into a small closet with a few extra organizational tools.

3. Ceiling racks

The most dramatic difference I've ever found with ceiling storage (in addition to the extra pots and pans storage in the kitchen) is in the garage or workshop-type rooms. Cruise your local home improvement box store. You'll find all sorts of support racks to hold holiday decorations, bicycles, lawn tools, and more.

4. Group containers in larger containers

This can mean large freezer bags, giant jars, or clear plastic storage bins with snap-on lids. How much easier is it if all the extra cord adapters, for example, are in one clear bag in a drawer rather than all tumbling about mixed in with other things? This also works for such items as flavored baking extracts, nail polish bottles, twist ties and bread tabs, etc. One thing we've been using for the first time this year is those galvanized steel rectangular bins that look like the old-